MC 451 Definitions Practice rubric

25 points. Due Friday, October 16, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 25. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Submissions are unlimited before the deadline, so you can revise and submit again.

- Each row looks across all of your variables. Four variables done fully is the assignment; a fifth earns nothing extra.

Definitions Practice, 25 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Conceptual definition 4 points	**4 points.** Every variable says in one or two sentences what it means in the abstract: what it is meant to capture.	**3 points.** Every variable has one, but one or two read as a list of examples instead of saying what the variable captures.	**2 points.** Some variables have none, or the conceptual and operational definitions say the same thing.	**0 to 1 points.** Missing from most variables.
Operational definition 7 points	**7 points.** Every variable says exactly what a coder does to assign a value, with an action a coder performs (count, mark, check whether), clear enough that a stranger could follow it and reach your answer.	**5 to 6 points.** Every variable has a procedure, but at least one leaves a step to the coder's judgment, so two careful readers could follow it and disagree.	**4 points.** At least one operational definition repeats the conceptual one in different words. This is the mistake the assignment exists to catch: if it has no action a coder performs, it is not an operational definition yet.	**0 to 3 points.** Most variables have no procedure a coder could follow.
Level of measurement 3 points	**3 points.** Named for every variable (nominal, ordinal, interval or ratio), and it matches the coded values.	**2 points.** Named for every variable, but one does not match its values (for example, ordered values called nominal).	**1 point.** Named for some variables only.	**0 points.** Missing.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Coded values 4 points	**4 points.** Every value is listed with what it means, and every item fits exactly one value, including an "other" or "none" value where one is needed.	**3 points.** Values are listed with meanings, but one variable has no place for items that fit none of them, or two values overlap.	**2 points.** Values are listed without saying what each means, or the list trails off ("etc.").	**0 to 1 points.** Missing for most variables.
Edge-case decision rules 7 points	**7 points.** Every variable has at least two edge cases, each written as a rule a coder can apply ("Emote-only messages are coded 0"), drawn from cases that come up in your material.	**5 to 6 points.** Two per variable, but at least one is an intention ("be careful with sarcasm") instead of a rule.	**4 points.** Some variables have one edge case or none.	**0 to 3 points.** No rules, or intentions only.

Before you submit

Codebook Check reads a pasted definition block and reports which variables are missing a conceptual or an operational definition, a level of measurement, or a catch-all category. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.